LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Foundation Years (Class 6 to 10): Olympiads, Scholarships and the Class 10 Decision

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This document is the common starting point for every stream and umbrella. Dates are for the 2026-27 cycle and are compiled from publicly available sources; items marked **[VERIFY]** are subject to confirmation against the official notifications of SOF, IAPT, HBCSE, NCERT, DSERT, KSEAB and CBSE. See section 9 (Source and confidence log).

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Class 6	Age 11-12	Start Olympiads and reading habits; Sainik School entry (AISSEE) is possible	Early exam practice, school-level routes
Class 7	Age 12-13	Try Maths and Science olympiads; explore hobbies and sports	Skill building across subjects
Class 8	Age 13-14	NMMS scholarship test; IOQM (Maths Olympiad) open from Class 8; RIMC entry **[VERIFY]**	Scholarship (Class 9-12) and olympiad ladder
Class 9	Age 14-15	Junior Science Olympiad (NSEJS) possible; Sainik School entry at Class 9; choose Maths level (CBSE)	Olympiads, NTSE preparation
Class 10	Age 15-16	Board exams; NTSE; the big decision: stream and pathway	Stream choice, polytechnic / ITI / Agniveer options
After Class 10	Age 16+	Class 11-12 (PUC in Karnataka), diploma, ITI, Agniveer, or other routes	Pathway documents for each umbrella

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-8: Explore and build

- Build reading, writing, Maths and Science basics. Try Olympiads for exposure, not pressure; sports, arts, quizzes and debates are equally valuable.
- Class 8 is the first key checkpoint: NMMS scholarship test (for government, aided and local body schools) and IOQM (Maths Olympiad) become available.

Class 9-10: Prepare and decide

- Maths level: in CBSE, Class 10 has Standard and Basic Maths. Basic Maths students were allowed to take Mathematics in Class 11 under relaxations for 2023-24 and 2025-26, subject to the school confirming aptitude, but the relaxation is tied to the old scheme and may end when the new scheme of studies is implemented. Choose Standard if Maths may matter. Karnataka SSLC rules were not found. **[VERIFY with school and CBSE circular]**
- Class 10 is the exit point from school-level exams: stream choice (Science, Commerce, Arts), or diploma, ITI, Agniveer or other routes.
- Karnataka: after SSLC, Class 11-12 is the Pre-University Course (PUC). Common combinations: Science (PCMB, PCMC) and Commerce (HEBA, SEBA, CEBA and similar); the exact codes vary by college. Admissions usually open after SSLC results (May) with classes from June. **[VERIFY with DPUE]**

Choosing after Class 10

- Science PCB: medicine, health, agriculture, life sciences (see Science PCB document).
- Science PCM: engineering, architecture, defence technical, research (see Science PCM document).
- Commerce: CA, CS, CMA, management, economics, law (see Commerce document).

- Arts and Humanities: civil services, law, psychology, media, design, teaching (see Arts and Humanities document).
- Direct routes after Class 10: Polytechnic and ITI, Agniveer (Defence), skill courses (see Polytechnic and ITI, Defence, and Skills and Entrepreneurship documents).

3. Olympiads, scholarships and school-level exams (Class 6-10)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
SOF olympiads: NSO / ISO (Science), IMO (Maths), IEO (English), IGKO (GK)	Science Olympiad Foundation (SOF)	1-12	Level 1 at school, Level 2 for top performers. Some sources say NSO was renamed ISO **[VERIFY]**	2026-27: IMO 23 Oct, 26 Nov, 10 Dec; IEO 30 Sep, 27 Oct, 17 Nov; IGKO 22 Sep, 6 Oct, 3 Nov; NSO/ISO Level 1 30 Oct, 19 Nov, 3 Dec; Level 2 Feb 2027; school registration by 31 Aug **[VERIFY]**
IOQM (Maths) -> RMO -> INMO	HBCSE with MTAI	8-12 (born 1 Aug 2007 to 31 Jul 2014)	Three stages, then IMO selection camp	IOQM held 6 Sep 2026; RMO likely 15 Nov 2026; INMO likely 17 Jan 2027 **[VERIFY]**
NSEJS -> INJSO (Junior Science)	IAPT (not HBCSE); jso.indapt.org.in	9-10 (age window conflicts) **[VERIFY]**	NSEJS: 60 Q, 2 hr, Physics, Chemistry, Biology; then INJSO	NSEJS 22 Nov 2026 (registration 21 Aug - 14 Sep, fee 300); INJSO about first week Feb 2027 **[VERIFY]**
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8 (govt, aided and local body schools)	Single written test; 12,000 per year in Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb (last held 1 Feb 2026)
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10	Stage 1 state, Stage 2 national; scholarship amounts not confirmed	Notification awaited; Stage 1 expected around Nov-Dec 2026 **[VERIFY]**
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	6-12	School nominates up to 5 ideas; 10,000 award	Last nominations closed 15 Sep 2025; check inspireawards-dst.gov.in
AISSEE (Sainik School entrance)	NTA	6 and 9	Offline OMR; boys and girls; 2026 exam 18 Jan	Registration usually Oct-Nov **[VERIFY]**
NSE senior olympiads (NSEP, NSEC, NSEA, NSEB)	IAPT then HBCSE	10-12 / 11-12	See Science documents	NSEA 21 Nov, NSEP / NSEC / NSEB 22 Nov 2026

Tip for parents: Olympiads do not decide admission but sharpen concepts. Choose one or two that fit your child; keep sports, arts, reading and rest in balance.

4. Key decisions and checkpoints

Class 10 Maths decision (CBSE)	
Standard Maths	Keeps every stream open (PCM, Economics Hons, Actuarial, Statistics, Architecture)
Basic Maths	Meant for students who do not plan to study Maths further; Maths in Class 11 was allowed in 2023-24 and 2025-26 with school approval; future rule may change **[VERIFY]**
Karnataka SSLC	No separate Basic / Standard Maths found at the time of compilation **[VERIFY]**

Class 10 to Class 11 in Karnataka (PUC)	
Board	Department of Pre-University Education (DPUE); colleges apply their own cutoffs
Science combinations	PCMB, PCMC; Biology or Computer Science as the fourth subject
Commerce combinations	HEBA, SEBA, CEBA and similar (codes vary) **[VERIFY]**
Timing	Applications after SSLC results (about May); classes from June **[VERIFY]**

Documents	SSLC marksheet, transfer certificate, photos, caste certificate if applicable

Sainik School and school-level defence entry	
Details	See the Defence document for AISSEE rules (Class 6 age 10-12; Class 9 age 13-15), reservation and timing **[VERIFY]**

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
School-level skills (coding, robotics, debate, MUN, chess, sports)	All students	Builds profile for any later stream
Tuition and learning support	All students	Choose reputable programmes; quality varies
Counselling after Class 10 (interest and aptitude tests)	Class 9-10	Use LessonPlan and school counsellors to compare options

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NTSE scholarship	NCERT	Successful Stage 2 candidates	Amounts not confirmed at the time of compilation	Notification awaited **[VERIFY]**
INSPIRE-MANAK award	DST with NIF	Nominated ideas, Class 6-12	10,000 one-time	School nomination cycle
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST) **[VERIFY: single source]**	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline **[VERIFY]**
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov **[VERIFY]**

Note: scholarship amounts and income limits change; always confirm on the official portal before applying. **[VERIFY]**

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
Class 11-12 (PUC / CBSE / ICSE)	2 yr	Class 10 pass	Stream choice drives the pathway
Polytechnic diploma	3 yr	SSLC; DTE counselling	See Polytechnic and ITI document
ITI trades	6 mo - 2 yr	Class 8 or 10 by trade	See Polytechnic and ITI document
Agniveer	4 yr service	Age 17.5-21; Class 10 / 12 by post	See Defence document
Skill courses	Weeks to months	Open enrolment	See Skills and Entrepreneurship document

Examples: Karnataka PUC colleges (government and private), CBSE / ICSE schools, Sainik Schools, government polytechnics and ITIs. **[VERIFY availability and admission rules]**

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Not a career stage yet	Class 6-10 is exploration: build skills, discover interests, keep academics strong	Choose a pathway after Class 10 using the umbrella documents

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCB, Science PCM, Commerce, Arts and Humanities: stream documents for after Class 10.
- Law, Design and Architecture, Health and Allied, Agriculture, Defence, Hospitality-Aviation-Maritime, Sports and Arts: umbrella documents.
- Polytechnic and ITI, Skills and Entrepreneurship: direct routes after Class 8 or 10.

9. Source and confidence log

Confidence reflects the type of source available. Items rely on publicly available secondary sources unless stated otherwise.

Item	Finding	Confidence
SOF olympiads 2026-27	IMO 23 Oct / 26 Nov / 10 Dec; IEO 30 Sep / 27 Oct / 17 Nov; IGKO 22 Sep / 6 Oct / 3 Nov; NSO/ISO L1 30 Oct / 19 Nov / 3 Dec; L2 Feb 2027; NSO may be renamed ISO; registration deadline conflicts	Medium
IOQM / RMO / INMO	HBCSE brochure (official): Class 8-12; IOQM 6 Sep 2026; RMO / INMO dates from secondary source	High for IOQM; Medium after
NSEJS / INJSO	IAPT; NSEJS 22 Nov 2026, 60 Q, 2 hr; registration 21 Aug - 14 Sep; INJSO about Feb 2027; age window conflicts; IAPT runs both	Medium
NTSE 2026-27	Notification awaited; Stage 1 expected Nov; scholarship amounts not found	Low-Medium
CBSE Basic Maths rule	Relaxations for 2023-24 and 2025-26; may end with new scheme; Karnataka SSLC not found	Medium for CBSE; Low for Karnataka
Karnataka PUC combinations	PCMB, PCMC, HEBA / SEBA / CEBA; codes vary by source; admissions after SSLC results	Medium / Low

Still to verify on official sites

- SOF official schedule and the NSO/ISO name; IAPT NSEJS brochure (age window); HBCSE RMO / INMO dates; NTSE 2026-27 notification and scholarship amounts.
- CBSE circular for the 2026-27 Basic Maths rule; Karnataka SSLC Maths structure; DPUE combination codes and admission calendar.
- Official sources: sofworld.org, iapt.org.in, jso.indapt.org.in, olympiads.hbcse.tifr.res.in, ncert.nic.in, dsert.kar.nic.in, kseab.karnataka.gov.in, cbse.gov.in, pue.karnataka.gov.in.
- Dates shift every year. Replace "tentative month" with the official notification date before publishing.

ONE-PAGE GIST: Foundation (Class 6-10)

Items marked **[VERIFY]** are subject to confirmation against official notifications (see the detailed document).

Stage	What to do
Class 6-7	Reading, Maths, Science basics; try Olympiads, sports, arts; AISSEE (Sainik School) at Class 6
Class 8	NMMS scholarship test; IOQM (Maths Olympiad) opens; RIMC **[VERIFY]**
Class 9	NSEJS (Junior Science); Maths level decision (CBSE); Sainik School at Class 9
Class 10	Boards; NTSE; decide stream or direct route
After Class 10	PUC (PCMB / PCMC / Commerce / Arts), diploma, ITI, Agniveer
Next step	Open the Science, Commerce, Arts or umbrella document for your goal

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
SOF olympiads (NSO/ISO, IMO, IEO)	Sep-Dec; Level 2 Feb	School-based Level 1 then Level 2	Check SOF
IOQM / RMO / INMO	Sep / Nov / Jan	Class 8-12 Maths ladder	Check HBCSE
NSEJS / INJSO	Nov / Feb	Class 9-10 Junior Science; 60 Q, 2 hr	Check IAPT
NMMS	Jan-Feb (Class 8)	Scholarship test; 12,000 per year	Check DSERT
NTSE	Stage 1 Nov-Dec **[VERIFY]**	Class 10 national talent scholarship	Check NCERT
AISSEE	Jan (Class 6 / 9)	Sainik School entrance; offline OMR	Check NTA

Key rules: keep Standard Maths if Maths may matter; PUC admissions follow SSLC results; Olympiads sharpen but do not decide admission. **[VERIFY]**

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), NTSE, INSPIRE-MANAK. **[VERIFY amounts and deadlines]**

Careers: not yet; use this stage to explore and then pick the pathway document.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.